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**GREEN DAY
MAKE DREAMS
COME TRUE
FOR FANS
IN THE
REGION**



Afra Al Nofeli / Gulf News

AL HOSN FESTIVAL: JOIN IN THE CELEBRATION OF UAE HERITAGE

Experience Abu Dhabi's rich heritage at the Al Hosn Festival, an annual showcase of the culture and traditions of the Emirati community, being held at Qasr Al Hosn, Abu Dhabi's oldest building. The festival which kicked off on January 25 runs till February 9.

Scan the QR code to watch the video



UAE warns residents about online shopping scams

Public urged to verify adverts and use only secure payment methods

ABU DHABI
BY ABDULLA RASHEED
Abu Dhabi Editor

If a shopping deal online sounds too good to be true, resist the urge to snap it up immediately, the UAE Cybersecurity Council has urged shoppers.

In its latest warning, the authority has sounded an alert about frauds targeting online shoppers, advising users to verify the ad and use only secure payment methods.

"Fraudulent shopping messages often include fake offers and discounts, suspicious links, and language designed to pressure shoppers into acting quickly to take advantage of a so-called opportunity before it expires, leading to significant cybersecurity risks," the council said. Last year, more than 38 million phishing attacks were recorded as cybercriminals exploited the

38million
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in the UAE

increase in online activity and seasonal shopping trends.

One way to avoid the scams is to verify that website uses the secure HTTPS protocol and displays trusted payment system icons and logos. Also, if the offer is genuine, shoppers should use payment gateways secured by using platforms with SSL encryption and trusted verification badges.

They have also been advised by the Council to ignore transactions with "unreliable or suspicious merchants".

"Avoid phishing links by never entering payment details through links received via email or text messages, and instead, visiting the site directly," it said.

SEE ALSO P2

Grade 10 student cherishes special high-five moment

'Once-in-a-lifetime,' says Abu Dhabi girl

ABU DHABI
BY ASHWANI KUMAR
Chief Reporter

Monica Akkineni, a Grade 10 student at Merryland International School in Abu Dhabi, is basking in the glory after a sustainable and eco-friendly project she developed with her classmate Muskan Maheshwari clinched the Zayed Sustainability Prize.

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan presenting the award to Akkineni



was the perfect icing on the cake.

"It was an amazing feeling," Akkineni recalled. "Meeting His Highness was a once-in-a-lifetime opportunity. Walking out there and meeting him, even though it seemed very intimidating at first, he was very patient and kind." As she was about to leave, the President gave her a high-five – the highlight of the encounter. "The President gave me a high five. It was a memorable moment," she said.

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SPORT

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Calls mount against relocation of Gazans

EGYPT DENIES REPORTS OF TRUMP-AL SISSI PHONE CALL

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

France yesterday became the latest country to voice opposition against American President Donald Trump's plans to relocate Gazans to Egypt and Jordan.

"Any forced displacement of the population in Gaza would be unacceptable," a French foreign ministry spokesman said when asked about Trump's comments.

"It would not only be a serious violation of international law, but also a major hindrance to the two-state solution," the spokesman said, referring to calls for Israeli and Palestinian states living side-by-side.

It would also be a "destabilisation factor (for) our close allies Egypt and Jordan".

No forced displacement

Earlier Egypt, Jordan and Palestinian Authority president Mahmud Abbas had also strongly opposed Trump's proposal.

Jordan yesterday renewed its rejection of Trump's proposal.

ISRAEL DEFIES UN

Israel will cease all contact with the UN's Palestinian relief agency UNRWA and any other body acting on its behalf, its UN envoy said yesterday, after repeatedly accusing the organisation of undermining its security. "The legislation forbids UNRWA from operating within the sovereign territory of the State of Israel, and forbids any contact between Israeli officials and UNRWA," said the envoy, Danny Danon. "Israel will terminate all collaboration, communication and contact with UNRWA or anyone acting on its behalf," he said.

"We emphasise that Jordan's national security dictates that the Palestinians must remain on their land and that the Palestinian people must not be subjected to any kind of forced displacement whatsoever," Jordanian government spokesman Mohammad Momani said

On Sunday, the Arab League warned against "attempts to uproot the Palestinian people from their land". "The forced displacement and eviction of people from their land can only be called ethnic cleansing," the regional bloc's general secretary said in a statement.

In a related development, Egypt said yesterday that President Abdul Fattah Al Sissi did not speak by phone with Trump at the weekend on the proposed relocation of Palestinians from Gaza. "A senior official source denied what some media outlets reported about a phone call between the Egyptian and American presidents," Egypt's state information service said, adding that any such contact would have been announced.

On Monday, Trump reportedly said he and Al Sissi had spoken, saying of Al Sissi: "I wish he would take some." The Egyptian foreign ministry on Sunday released a statement rejecting "any infringement on Palestinians' inalienable rights to their land", whether "temporarily or long-term".

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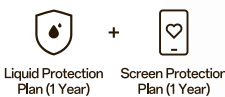
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